



**The Selectboard**  
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON  
TOWN HALL  
1 SOUTH ROAD  
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

**Minutes of the Meeting**  
**Wednesday, February 9, 2026, 7:30 PM**  
**at the Town Hall, 1 South Road**

**Call to Order**

The Selectboard was called to order at 8:03 PM

*PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (Chair), Scott Johndrow, Jennifer Milikowsky*

*ALSO PRESENT: Douglas Finn, Others as noted.*

**Public comment on any item not on the agenda**

No comments from the public.

**Contract Review / Endorsement – Purchase and Sale Agreement for “O’Conner” and “Murgo” parcels**

*Selectboard will review and may sign.*

*Mr. Aaron Nelson, Mass Audubon, was present.*

The final Purchase and Sale Agreement, and revised and approved by Counsel, was reviewed.

After brief deliberation, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the purchase and sale agreement, and to sign.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:06 PM)**

**Discussion / Deliberation: Amendment to Personnel Policy, Section 9.1 “Plans”**

*Board will consider the impacts of a change to the Employer / Employee “split” for group health insurance premiums. Discussion. Votes may be taken.*

*Present: Kelly O’Connor, Shelby Marowitz, Tad Weiss.*

Ms. Milikowsky noted that, while an unpalatable subject to consider, the Town may have to consider making changes to the cost sharing ‘split’ for group health insurance. Currently, the town pays 75%, and employees pay 25% of group health insurance premiums.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that group health insurance is a significant part of the budget, and the anticipated budget increases; therefore the budget would need to be negotiated.

Ms. Milikowsky also noted that, until the town’s overall financial picture is clearer, any decision on the subject would be premature.

Ms. Bronstein agreed.

Mr. Tad Weiss, Finance Committee chair, asked for more information about what other towns pay for as a percentage. Mr. Finn presented statistics on 18 towns, showing that Westhampton is in line with about 13 other towns in the region. More data will be forthcoming.

Ms. O’Connor suggested that changing the split could have an impact on paraprofessionals, as they would likely seek a situation with better insurance terms.

The matter was tabled by consensus to an unspecified later date.

**Discussion: Proposition 2-1/2 Override**

*Board will consider a proposal to hold a special town meeting and special election for the purpose of*

*considering and/or implementing a proposition 2-1/2 override*

Ms. Milikowsky asked the board to entertain a Proposition 2-1/2 override.

Ms. Milikowsky suggested that there are reasons to consider a Proposition 2-1/2 override sooner rather than later, in order to understand whether or not the Town will consider a proposition 2-1/2 override.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that understanding the town's appetite for a Proposition 2-1/2 override going into town meeting would allow the Town to more confidently prepare and defend school and town budgets.

Mr. Weiss suggested that the elementary school budget was of concern, and the certainty of that budget would seem to be an important factor.

There was continued discussion on the potential of holding a special town meeting to consider a proposition 2-1/2 override. The board generally concurred with a schedule that would push both the Special Town Meeting, and the Election, as far forward in the schedule as possible.

There was further discussion relative to the timing of public hearings, special town meeting, and the special election.

The board recognized the need to present a solid budget to voters at the Special Town Meeting if a prop 2-1/2 override is considered, and on the necessity to put the question before the voters.

The question turned to whether or not a proposition 2-1/2 override might be repeated at the annual election if the special election override vote fails.

The board agreed with the need to keep voters informed throughout the process, particularly about the overall structural deficit.

Ms. O'Connor suggested that the Selectboard should be at the Elementary School Committee meeting the following night to ensure that they are well informed about the Town's situation. The board agreed at least one member should attend the meeting.

Ms. O'Connor and Ms. Marowitz were thanked for their time.

#### **Discussion: – Filing of Investment Tax Credit for Solar Projects**

*Board will discuss the filing of the ITC for solar projects.*

*Present: Mr. Dan Abrahamson, Hampshire Group Energy Manager*

Mr. Abrahamson Presented information relative to the town's desire to seek the invested tax credit for various Westhampton Solar Projects, including the Town Hall solar, and the Public Safety Complex array.

Mr. Abrahamson noted that the Town Hall project would likely cost about \$3,000 in filing fees, but would result in a return of about \$16,500.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that the town is looking at candidates for the posted accountant position, and a person with that skillset would be beneficial to the town.

There was discussion about the timing of the matter, and the benefit to the town of getting the filing done quickly.

After extensive discussion, it was MOVED by Milikowsky SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the proposal of engaging the accountant, and to authorize Susan Bronstein to sign the engagement letter on behalf of the board.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:40 PM)**

#### **Contract Review: Purchase and Installation Agreement for Westhampton Elementary School Solar**

*Selectboard will review and may sign.*

Ms. Milikowsky noted that the Purchase and Sale agreement for the Westhampton Elementary Solar project was not ready for signature, due to final negotiations with the vendor, and determination about fees.

There was discussion about the review of the project by the fire chief.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that the contract would likely be ready to sign at the next meeting.

### **Administrative**

#### **Selectboard Member Concerns**

*Selectboard members may raise topics of new business or propose future action items. Consensus advice and direction on any topic may be given.*

Ms. Milikowsky noted that the Regional School Finance Committee had voted to recommend a 5.66% increase to local assessments; this would result in an increase to Westhampton's assessment by \$40,290, or a total of \$1,627,091 for Fiscal 2027.

#### **Review of Correspondence if any**

Correspondence was reviewed. No action taken on any specific item.

#### **Review and Approve A/P and Payroll Warrants #W26-16 and #WP26-16**

Warrants were reviewed. After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

*To approve the warrants as presented.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:53 PM)**

#### **Review and Approve Meeting Minutes if available**

The minutes of January 28, 2026 were reviewed. It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

*To approve the minutes of the January 28, 2026 , 7 PM, meeting as presented.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:56 PM)**

Approval of the minutes of January 28, 2026, 6 PM, were returned to the Town Coordinator for revision.

### **Adjourn**

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

*To Adjourn.*

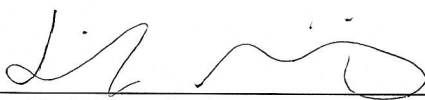
**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:56 PM)**

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**Approved** by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on February 23, 2026.

  
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Susan Bronstein

  
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Scott Johndrow

  
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Jennifer Milikowsky